IMPERIAL PARLIAMENT.

HOUSE OF COMMONS

SATURDAY.

The SPEAKER took the chair at a quarter-past twelve o'clock.

IRELAND AND THE BANKRUPTCY BILL.

Mr. DALY presented petitions from Ireland and many large towns in England in favour of improvements in the Bankruptcy Procedure in Ireland, and making it in harmony with the alteration proposed to be applied by the Bankruptcy Bill to England.

Mr. CALLAN asked the Attorney-General for Ireland whether, in the event of his proceeding with the clauses of which he had given notice for the purpose of extending the Bankruptcy Bill to Ireland, he would be prepared to introduce further clauses expressly re-enacting the several clauses of the Bankruptcy and Insolvency Act, 1857, and the Bankruptcy Amendment (Ireland) Act, 1872, which it was proposed not to repeal, so as to make the present bill as complete a code for Ireland as it would be for England; and whether, in the event of his not doing so, he would be prepared to accept and adopt the amendments requisite to expressly introduce such clauses, instead of leaving it to the Irish Courts hereafter to determine how far those Acts of 1857 and 1872 are consistent or inconsistent with the present bill, as is contemplated by the clauses of which he had given notice.

The ATTORNEY GENERAL for IRELAND said he had already answered the question in substance in reply to the hon. member for Carlow. It was not at present the intention of the Government to make any alteration in the Irish clauses, or to introduce the clauses referred to; but any suggestion, of course, would be carefully considered.

Mr. CALLAN asked whether the clauses extending the Bankruptcy Bill to Ireland, which appeared on the paper, were identical in principle with the clauses proposed before the Standing Committee.

The SOLICITOR-GENERAL for IRELAND said the clauses placed on the paper in the first instance had been revised; but in substance they were the same.

THE CRIMINAL APPEAL BILL.

Mr. M. LLOYD asked the Attorney-General on ...

... with those already passed by the judges. The rules were much shorter than those which were recommended by a committee of judges, and instead of being of a radical nature were drawn in a most conservative spirit. The judges might, in his opinion, have gone much farther towards the abolition of trial by jury, and followed an example already set by the United States and Scotland. Such a technical legal subject should be left to a professional body of men to settle, as had been proved already by the confused and unsatisfactory shape in which the Criminal Appeal Bill had left the Grand Committee.

Mr. BULWER had no wish to consider at the present moment either the merits or demerits of these rules, but he desired to impress on the House that there was no such urgent haste and hurry as had been represented.

Mr. H. FOWLER urged the House to consider this question from a public point of view, and from a standpoint entirely outside the legal profession. There was a growing and a general feeling of dissatisfaction throughout the country with the present administration of justice in the supreme courts. (Hear, hear.) The Judicature Acts had been a failure in many ways. They had increased the cost of obtaining justice, and had enormously increased the delay. (Cheers.) It was a matter for great regret that at the fag end of August they should be discussing one of the most serious questions that had arisen during the present Parliament. As an illustration of the state of things, he might mention that there were 1,100 cases waiting for trial in the Queen's Bench Division in November. Such a scandal as this demanded the immediate attention of Parliament. He did not think the remedy was to be found in increasing the number of judges; what was required was a thorough rearrangement of the whole system. He was glad to say that he regarded that those proposed new rules as, on the whole, a decided step in the path of reform. (Hear, hear.) The judges themselves were not law reformers, as a rule—and never would be. (Cheers.) He would to-day advise the House, at this period of the session to thankfully accept these rules, and ask for more. One of the most urgent reforms needed was in reference to the vacation; 127 days, or 18 weeks and one day, were taken out of the year for the different vacations, and during all this time justice was practically denied to her Majesty's subjects. This was insisted upon by the legal profession. He did not wish to oppose ...

THE WALTHAMSTOW TRAGEDY.

On Saturday, at Stratford Petty Sessions, before Messrs. N. Powell, J. Spicer, W. W. Glenny, and A. Lister, William Gouldstone, described as a whitesmith, of 8, Courtenay-place, St. James's-street, Walthamstow, was brought up, on remand, charged with having wilfully murdered on Wednesday last his five children, namely, Charles Gouldstone, three and a half years old; Herbert Gouldstone, two and a half years old; and Frederick Gouldstone, aged 15 months, by drowning them in a cistern in the house; and two infants, twins, seven days old, by striking them on the head with a hammer as they lay in bed by the side of their mother. A crowd assembled outside the court-house, in the hope of gaining admission, and the court itself was crowded. The prisoner, a young man of low stature and fair complexion, with a slight moustache, upon being placed in the dock, nodded complacently in recognition to Mrs. Hamilton, a lodger at 8, Courtenay-place, and nurse to Mrs. Gouldstone, but Mrs. Hamilton, who was seated with other witnesses at the side of the court facing the dock, did not appear to notice the nod of the prisoner. The accused then folded his arms and leaned upon the dock rail while the charge was read over to him. Mr. Atkinson, solicitor, of Stratford, appeared for the defence.

Mrs. Hamilton was recalled, and the evidence she gave at the former examination read over to her. This evidence, detailing the nature of the crime, has been already published. The prisoner looked calmly around the court, and with firmly compressed lips, maintained a stolid demeanour till the point in the evidence of Mrs. Hamilton where she identified a piece of cord that she saw the prisoner handling in the kitchen of the house just before the murders. When this cord was held up by a policeman for identification by the witness the prisoner pointed significantly to his throat. The hammer used by the prisoner was also produced and identified by the witness.

After the evidence of Mrs. Hamilton had been read over, Mr. Wells (the clerk to the magistrate) asked Inspector Craggs, who represented the police, if he wished a further remand to be granted.

Inspector Craggs: Yes. The Treasury will take up the prosecution, and I ask for an adjournment for a week.

Mr. Atkinson said he had a few questions to put to the witness, Mrs. Hamilton, but if the magistrates were going to again remand the prisoner, perhaps he had better defer them till the next hearing.

The magistrates decided to remand the prisoner for a week, and the cross-examination of Mrs. Hamilton was deferred till then.

ELECTRIC LIGHTING IN THE METROPOLIS.

On Saturday a Select Committee of the House of Lords, consisting of the Duke of Buckingham and Chandos (chairman), the Duke of Westminster, Lord Carrington, the Marquis of Lothian and Lord Lovat, held an inquiry into the provisional orders for the supply of electric light to St. James's and St. Martin's-in-the-Fields, and the Strand district. The Swan and Edison companies have obtained a provisional order for lighting these districts, and they are opposed by the Jablochkoff Company and the Strand District Board of Works. It was stated that the Jablochkoff Company had indemnified the Strand district against all expenses. Mr. Meysey Thompson represented the Board of Trade, Mr. Pope, Q.C., and Mr. Moulton the Swan and Edison companies; and Mr. Pember, Q.C., and Mr. Jeune the Strand District and the Jablochkoff Company respectively; and Mr. Cripps (Dyson and Company) for the inhabitants of the district.

It was arranged that the position of the Board of Trade should be explained to the committee, and for this purpose,

Mr. T. H. FARRER, the permanent secretary of the Board, was the first witness called. He stated that he did not appear as the promoter or opponent of any of the schemes, but simply to state what had been the action of the Board of Trade under the Act of last session. The Electric Lighting Act was passed after very careful discussion before a Select Committee, and what it did was this. (He described its principle features.) Of a large number of provisional orders which were now receiving the assent of Parliament the conditions made had met with the concurrence of the local authorities in all cases except in the case of two or three London vestries. He might say that from some of the London vestries they had received the greatest assistance. Then he might say that a very large number of applications were received at the Board of Trade, both as regarded the metropolis and the country, last autumn. Those applications were matters of long consultation between the Board of Trade and the various local authorities. In the end a model order was framed with their assistance, which was circulated in the course of the early spring to the various local authorities and companies, and upon that model order the subsequent provisional orders were framed. The Board of Trade considered that the private lighting was by far the most important part of the concern. The orders when granted did not constitute a monopoly—that was to say, supposing it should prove profitable at the end of 21 years the whole thing might be bought up, and in the meantime those persons who had got the order would ...

THE CONDITIONS OF RIVERSIDE LABOUR.

UNIVERSITY INTELLIGENCE.

CAMBRIDGE, Aug. 11.

HIGHER LOCAL EXAMINATIONS.—The classlists for these examinations, which were held in June last at the following centres—Birmingham, Bradford, Brighton, Bristol, Cambridge, Cheltenham, Croydon, Exeter, Hampstead, Leeds, Liverpool, London, Manchester, Newcastle-on-Tyne, Newcastle (Staff.), Norwich, Nottingham, Plymouth, Ripon, Sydenham, and Winchester, were issued yesterday. The number of candidates examined were 987, and in the various classes the following passed:—Religious knowledge, 131; English subjects, 296; languages, 279; arithmetic and mathematics, 83; political economy and logic, 58; botany, chemistry, geology, physics, physiology, and zoology, 35; music, 30; history subjects, 134. The Divinity prize was awarded to Miss J. P. Kitchener, Bedford; and the Lowman Memorial prize to Miss A. F. Stone, Amhurst road, Hackney. The supplementary tables which have been issued in connection with the class lists of the above examinations, contain a mass of interesting information. These examinations were instituted in 1869 for women, but in 1873 they were opened to men, without, however, attracting many of the latter, for out of a total of 987 offered this year for examination only 22 were men. Of the total number of candidates 718 passed one or more of the eight groups of subjects; 481 passed only one group, 191 in two groups, 42 in three groups, and four passed in four subjects. Of the latter, three were at the Liverpool centre, and one at the London centre. At Birmingham, out of 40 women entered 29 passed—19 in one, 9 in two, and 1 in three groups. Of the 8 men 6 passed—3 in one, 2 in two, and 1 in three groups. At Bradford, out of 22 women entered, 14 passed—7 in one and 7 in two groups. At Brighton, out of 22 women entered, 14 passed—7 in one, and 7 in two groups. At Bristol there were 53 women candidates; 42 passed—32 in one, 9 in two, and 1 in three groups. At Cambridge 94 women entered, 74 of whom passed—49 in one, 24 in two, and 1 in three groups. The solitary man examined at this centre passed in one subject only, music. At Cheltenham, out of 45 women entered, 29 passed—14 in one, 11 in two, and 4 in three groups. At Croydon out of 12 candidates, 9 passed—3 in one, and 6 in two groups. At Exeter 20 entered, 15 passed—11 in one, 2 in two, and 2 in three groups. At Hampstead there were 52 passed out of 69 candidates—31 in one, 17 in two, and 7 in three groups. At Leeds 40 women entered, 31 passed, 29 in one, 2 in two, and 3 in three groups. Two men entered, one of whom passed in one group. At Liverpool 59 entered, and 40 passed—30 in one, 6 in two, 1 in three, and 3 in four groups of subjects. At London 240 women were candidates, and of these 171 succeeded—110 in one, ...

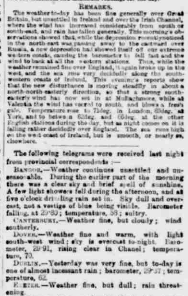
THREE BROTHERS DROWNED IN THE THAMES.

Shortly after five o'clock on Saturday evening, a distressing scene was witnessed by some hundreds of people from the Chelsea Embankment. Three men engaged a boat of a boat-builder, at Old Battersea Bridge, and as they were making for Wakeley's Wharf on the Surrey side one of the men rose up in the boat, causing her to cant, and before they could recover themselves the skiff capsized. The men were subsequently seen struggling together, and before a boat could reach them two had sunk, clasped together, and never rose again. The third man was also drowned. Several boats put off and the crews dragged for the bodies. In the meantime the Thames Police were communicated with, and soon after were engaged in recovering the bodies with their drags. The spot where the men sank was pointed out, and Acting-Inspector Abbott succeeded in the first drag to catch hold of two of the men. Just as they were got to the surface of the water one slipped off, and was carried away on the top of the flood, but was eventually recovered by a waterman. The river police, as the bodies were recovered, removed them on an ambulance to the Chelsea Mortuary, where they were afterwards identified as three brothers. It is stated that the youngest had only come out of an hospital a few days prior to the fatal catastrophe. The eldest was a widower, and leaves three children, while the second son had received his discharge from the Army. The names of the drowned men are William Kimber, aged 27 years; Richard Kimber, aged 22 years; and Charles Kimber, aged 30 years. Great sympathy is felt for the father of the young men, who lives in Chelsea, and has been beadle of a chapel there for 28 years.

DESTRUCTION OF A MUSIC HALL BY FIRE.

Durland's Star Music Hall, in Upper Sans-street, Sunderland, was entirely destroyed by fire on Saturday evening. The flames broke out in the interior of the building, near the roof above the stage. Constable Sanderson, who was on duty, reports that the fire broke out at half-past seven o'clock, and the first efforts of himself and the proprietors were used to get the audience, which he ...

THE WEATHER.



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